

CITY OF SOUTH MILWAUKEE
OFFICIAL PROCEEDINGS
OF THE COMMON COUNCIL
REGULAR MEETING

APRIL 21, 2026

The regular meeting of the Common Council was called to order at 7:00 p.m. on April 21, 2026, by Mayor Brett Briesemeister in the Common Council Chambers at South Milwaukee City Hall, 2424 15th Avenue, South Milwaukee, Wisconsin. On roll call Ald David Bartoshevich, Ald Peggy Clark, Ald Craig Maass, Ald Michal Olechowski, Ald Tim Backes, and Ald Joe Bukowski were present. Ald Lisa Pieper was excused.

The meeting was prefaced with the Pledge of Allegiance.

City Clerk Braatz administered the Oath of Office to the newly elected Mayor.

Clark/Backes nominated Bukowski to be Common Council President. There were no further nominations. Upon the closing of nominations, Clark/Bartoshevich moved to confirm the selection of Alderperson Bukowski as the new Council President for the term ending April 19, 2027. Upon roll call vote, motion carried 6-0.

Citizen comment period was opened at 7:09 p.m. and closed at 7:11 p.m.

Under President of the Council, Bukowski/Backes moved to adopt the following items in the consent agenda:

- a) Approval of minutes from the March 17, 2026 Common Council regular meeting and April 6, 2026 Common Council special meeting
- b) Acceptance of the resignation letter by Adult Services Librarian Lauryn Chesney, effective April 13, 2026.
- c) Acceptance of the resignation letter by member George Becker of the Planning Commission, effective May 1, 2026.
- d) Approval of a renewal application for a Secondhand Article Dealer license by ecoATM, LLC for the property located at 222 N. Chicago Avenue for the period ending December 31, 2026.
- e) Re-appointments for the following members:
 1. Donald DeMont, Board of Appeals, term ending April 30, 2029.
 2. Anthony Bloom, Board of Appeals, term ending April 30, 2029.
 3. Donna Plotz, Board of Review, term ending April 30, 2031.
 4. Carla Uphill, Board of Review, term ending April 30, 2031.
 5. Ericka Lang, Civic Grant Committee, term ending April 30, 2027.
 6. Melissa Ellis, Civic Grant Committee, term ending April 30, 2027.
 7. Tiffany LaBorde, Housing Authority, term ending April 30, 2031.
 8. Robert Weber, Police & Fire Commission, term ending April 30, 2031.
 9. Cassandra Hadley, South Milwaukee/St. Francis Board of Health, term ending April 30, 2029.
 10. Cyndi Kieck, South Milwaukee/St. Francis Board of Health, term ending April 30, 2029.
- f) Appointment of Brett Briesemeister as Mayoral member of Plan Commission for term ending April 16, 2029.
- g) Appointment of Kevin Worm and Patrick Brevier as citizen members of Plan Commission for terms ending April 30, 2029.
- h) Appointment of Joan Totka to the South Milwaukee/St. Francis Board of Health for terms ending April 30, 2029.
- i) Approval of the Schedule of Vouchers for the period March 1-31, 2026 in the amount of \$5,041,527.09.
- j) Approval of Financial Reports for the various funds for the period ending January 31, 2026.
- k) Approval of Financial Reports for the various funds for the period ending February 28, 2026.

Motion carried 6-0.

Under Finance Committee, Bukowski/Backes moved to approve a resolution authorizing the issuance and sale of \$7,635,000 General Obligation Promissory Notes, Series 2026A. Upon a roll call vote, motion carried 6-0.

Bukowski/Backes moved to approve a resolution approving the updates to the Purchasing Policy No. 93-03, revising the bidding and quotation thresholds. Motion carried 6-0.

Under Public Works and Public Property Committee, Maass/Olechowski moved to suspend the rules to allow for giving the first, second, and third readings on ordinances creating Subsection §9.04F and amending Section §9.08 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code related to tree enforcement and cost recovery, creating sections §34.12 through §34.52 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code related to construction site erosion and sediment control, post-construction storm water management, and illicit discharge, and creating section §10.29 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code relative to the abandonment of water service lines. Motion carried 6-0.

Maass/Olechowski moved to adopt an ordinance creating Subsection §9.04F and amending Section §9.08 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code related to tree enforcement and cost recovery. Motion carried 6-0.

Maass/Olechowski moved to adopt an ordinance creating sections §34.12 through §34.52 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code related to construction site erosion and sediment control, post-construction storm water management, and illicit discharge. The motion includes an amendment to Sec. §34.43 B. to read as follows, "Discharges resulting from firefighting activities, emergency response actions, or other emergency operations conducted or expressly authorized by the City." Motion carried 6-0.

Maass/Olechowski moved to approve change orders for Five Star Energy Services in the total amount of \$475,000 for asphalt and concrete restoration associated with the Lead Service Line Replacement project, Phases 2 and 3, with funding provided by the Capital Improvement Fund. Motion carried 6-0.

Maass/Olechowski moved to award the Phase 5 Lead Service Line Replacement project contract to Five Star Energy Services in an amount not to exceed \$2,679,100 with proceeds from the Wisconsin DNR Safe Drinking Water Fund Loan Program. Motion carried 6-0.

Under Unfinished Business – Economic Development, Bukowski/Backes moved to deny the proposed agreement with Savage Solutions for the South Milwaukee Sam campaign, and to direct City staff to develop a position description and implementation plan for an in-house communications program, and return to the Common Council at a later date. Motion carried 6-0.

Under Miscellaneous Business – City Clerk, City Clerk Braatz presented report on the April 7, 2026 Spring Election.

Bukowski/Backes moved to proceed with a process to appoint a successor to serve for the residue of the unexpired term for the Alderperson District 1 vacancy. Motion carried 6-0.

Bukowski/Backes moved to approve the process to appoint a successor to serve for the residue of the unexpired term for the Alderperson District 1 vacancy as outlined in the City Clerk memo dated April 16, 2026. Motion carried 6-0.

Mayor Briesemeister announced that there will be a special Common Council meeting on Monday, May 4, 2026 to conduct interviews for the Alderperson District 1 vacancy.

Under Miscellaneous Business – Water/Wastewater, Bukowski/Backes moved to adopt an ordinance creating Sec. §10.29 of the South Milwaukee Municipal Code relative to the abandonment of water service lines. Motion carried 6-0.

Bukowski/Backes moved to convene into closed session pursuant to Wis. Stats. 19.85(1)(e) for the purpose of deliberating or negotiating the purchasing of public properties, the investing of public funds, or conducting other specified business, whenever competitive bargaining reasons require a closed

session, specifically to discuss the potential purchase of 2931 S. Chicago Avenue and a potential lease agreement with Piggly Wiggly Midwest to open a grocery store business at 2931 S. Chicago Avenue located in Tax Increment District No. 3. Upon roll call, motion carried 6-0.

Bukowski/Maass moved to return to open session and take any necessary action on closed session items. Upon roll call, motion carried 6-0.

No action taken on the potential purchase of 2931 S. Chicago Avenue and a potential lease agreement with Piggly Wiggly Midwest to open a grocery store business at 2931 S. Chicago Avenue located in Tax Increment District No. 3.

There being no further business to discuss, Bartoshevich/Olechowski moved to adjourn the meeting at 8:14 p.m. Motion carried 6-0.

Respectfully Submitted,

Steven A. Braatz, Jr.
City Clerk

APPROVED: 5-5-26